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TAB 27



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-067-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 4/8/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Ortiz Franklin - Mandated Supporting: Child Abuse Awareness, Safety and Equity, (Res-067-24/25)
(Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD) Strategic Plan “Joy and Wellness” pillar represents the District’s commitment to serving the whole child - supporting students’ social, emotional, and physical health and wellness so they are prepared to focus on learning, growing, and building meaningful connections at school;

Whereas, The LAUSD Strategic Plan “Engagement and Collaboration” pillar commits to meaningful family engagement recognizing the importance of our families’ knowledge, traditions, and resources and the District is dedicated to strengthening these connections;

Whereas, The District recognizes the responsibility of all staff to protect students from abuse and neglect by becoming knowledgeable, well-trained and prepared on procedures for filing suspected child abuse reports;

Whereas, In 2022 82.5% of all reports to the LA County Child protection hotline were made by mandated reporters, such as educators, law enforcement, medical staff, and others required by law to report suspected abuse or neglect, and only 16% of allegations were substantiated;

Whereas, In 2022, Black children made up only 7.7% of LA County’s population but accounted for 19% of Child Protection Hotline reports, disproportionality exposing Black families to Child Protective Services at nearly 2.5 times the rate of non-Black families;

Whereas, In 2022 AB2805 redefined "general neglect" for purposes of the Child Abuse and Neglect Reporting Act (CANRA) by excluding a person's economic disadvantage and instead allows mandated reporters to offer support to families instead of reporting them;

Whereas, In 2023 the LA County Board of Supervisors passed the motion, “Evolving from Mandated Reporter to Mandated Supporter, shifting from “mandated reporting” to “mandating supporting” through supporting professionals in deciding whether families need Department of Children and Family Services intervention or community-based services. This includes improving decision-making tools, data analysis, expanding community services, and creating standardized training; and

Whereas, April is National Child Abuse Prevention Month, recognized by Congress in 1982 to raise awareness, promote support for families and advocate for prevention; now, therefore it be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District (Board) commits to a holistic vision beyond compliance towards compassion, promoting the safety of children and the support of families where there may be suspicion of neglect or abuse, aiming to keep all children safe,

reduce disparities for Black children and children living in poverty, and supporting all parents and caregivers with dignity and respect;

Resolved further, That the Board recognizes April as National Child Abuse Prevention Month in 2025 and every year thereafter; and be it finally;

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will review and revise its Child Abuse policies and trainings to align to the Board, County and State's requirements of a Mandated Supporting Protocol that is trauma-informed, equity-focused, and resource-connected.